Section 1. How This Plan Works

This Plan is a fee-for-service (FFS) plan. OPM requires that FEHB plans be accredited to validate that plan operations and/or care management meet nationally recognized standards. G.E.H.A holds the following accreditations: Health Plan Accreditation with Accreditation Association for Ambulatory Health Care (AAAHC) and Dental Network Accreditation with URAC. To learn more about this plan's accreditations, please visit the following websites: Accreditation Association for Ambulatory Health Care (www. aaahc.org); URAC (www. urac.org). You can choose your own physicians, facilities, and other healthcare providers. We give you a choice of enrollment in the Elevate or Elevate Plus plan.

We reimburse you or your provider for your covered services, usually based on a percentage of the amount we allow. The type and extent of covered services, and the amount we allow, may be different from other plans. Read brochures carefully.

General features of our Elevate Plus and Elevate Options

We have a Preferred Providers Organization (PPO) Network

Our fee-for-service plan offers in-network benefits through a PPO. This means that certain hospitals and other healthcare providers are "preferred providers." When you use our PPO providers, you will receive services at reduced cost. Providers in the network accept a contracted payment from us, and you will only be responsible for your cost-sharing (copayments, coinsurance, deductibles, and non-covered services and supplies).

- On the Elevate Option, you also have benefits to receive covered services from non-participating providers; however, out-of-network benefits may have higher out-of-pocket costs than the in-network benefits.
- Elevate Plus does not provide benefits for non-participating providers, except in cases of emergency medical care.

To find in-network providers, use the provider search tool on the geha.com/Locate-Care website or call G.E.H.A at 800-821-6136. When you call your provider for an appointment, please remember to verify that the physician is still an in-network provider. G.E.H.A in-network providers are required to meet licensure and certification standards established by State and Federal authorities; however, inclusion in the network does not represent a guarantee of professional performance nor does it constitute medical advice.

On the Elevate Option, the out-of-network benefits are the standard benefits of this Plan. Elevate Plus does not provide out-of-network benefits. On both Elevate and Elevate Plus, in-network benefits apply only when you use an in-network provider. Provider networks may be more extensive in some areas than others. We cannot guarantee the availability of every specialty in all areas. If no in-network provider is available, or you do not use an in-network provider, the standard out-of-network benefits apply on the Elevate Option. However, if the services are rendered at an in-network facility, the professionals who provide services to you may not all be preferred providers. If the services are rendered by out-of-network providers at an in-network facility, we will pay up to the Plan allowance according to the No Surprises Act.

Note: Members residing outside the United States and accessing providers within their area of residence without access to an in-network providers will be paid at the in-network level of benefits.

How we pay providers

Fee-for-service plans reimburse you or your provider for covered services. They do not typically provide or arrange for healthcare. Fee-for-service plans let you choose your own physicians, facilities and other healthcare providers.

We offer benefits through the UnitedHealthcare Choice Plus network of individual physicians, medical groups, and facilities. These Plan providers accept a negotiated payment from us, and you will only be responsible for your cost-sharing (copayments, coinsurance, deductibles, and non-covered services and supplies), which may vary by plan.

We utilize Optum's Ingenix Claim Editing System (iCES) for United Health Network providers and Optum's Claims Editing System (CES) for non-United Health Network providers to review claims for bundling, unbundling, upcoding and other billing and coding edits using criteria that includes, but is not limited to, National Correct Coding Initiative (NCCI) guidelines, Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) guidelines, and Commercial (UHC) guidelines.

We reserve the right to audit medical expenses to ensure that the provider's billed charges match the services that you received.